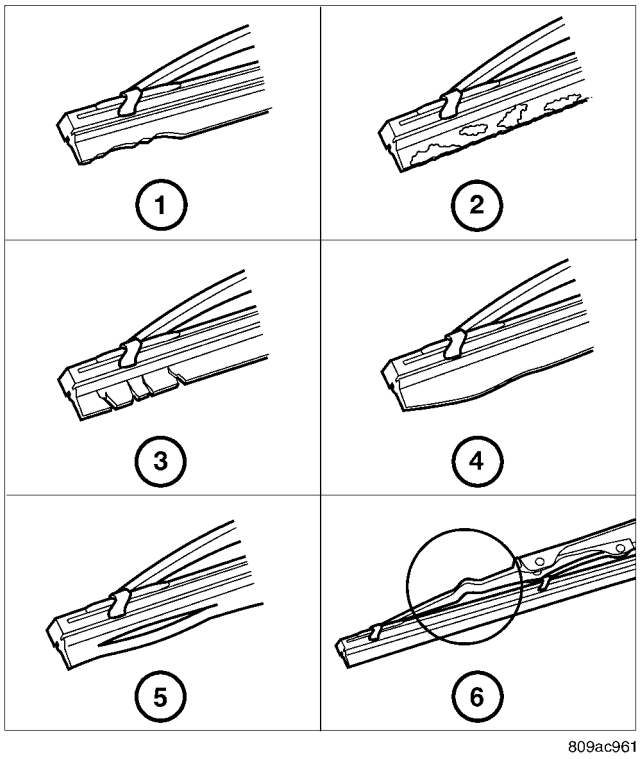

Fig. 2 Wiper Blade Inspection

1 - WORN OR UNEVEN EDGES
2 - ROAD FILM OR FOREIGN MATERIAL DEPOSITS
3 - HARD, BRITTLE, OR CRACKED
4 - DEFORMED OR FATIGUED
5 - SPLIT
6 - DAMAGED SUPPORT COMPONENTS

tor fittings. Whenever routing a washer hose or a wire harness containing a washer hose, it must be routed away from hot, sharp, or moving parts. Also, sharp bends that might pinch the washer hose must be avoided.

REAR CHECK VALVE

DESCRIPTION

Models equipped with the optional rear wiper and washer system have a rear check valve (Fig. 3). The rear check valve is located in the rear washer plumbing connection between the rear washer supply hose in the body wire harness and the rear washer supply hose in the hardtop wire harness, near the belt line in the left rear corner of the vehicle. The check valve consists of a molded plastic valve body with a raised center section that is tapered in the direction of the flow through the valve. A barbed hose nipple is formed on each side of the raised center section of the valve body. Within the check valve body, a small check ball is held against an integral valve seat by a small coiled spring. The rear check valve cannot be

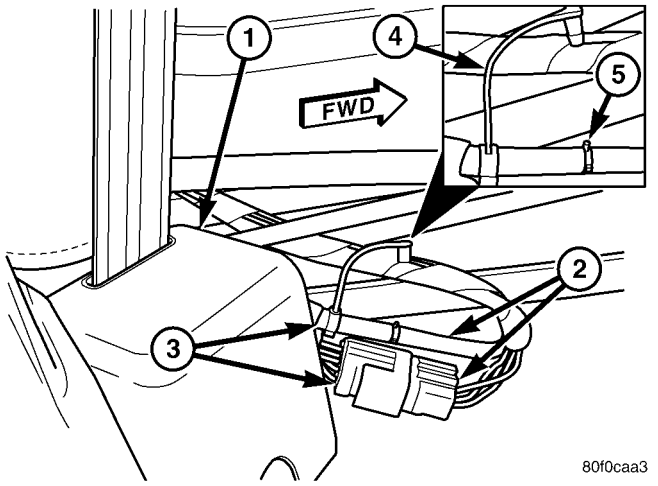

Fig. 3 Rear Check Valve

1 - LEFT REAR SEAT BELT RETRACTOR TRIM COVER
2 - HARDTOP WIRE HARNESS
3 - BODY WIRE HARNESS
4 - REAR WASHER HOSE CAP
5 - REAR CHECK VALVE

adjusted or repaired and, if faulty or damaged, it must be replaced.

OPERATION

The rear check valve provides more than one function in this application. It serves as an in-line connector fitting between the body and hardtop sections of the rear washer supply hose. It prevents washer fluid from draining out of the rear washer supply hoses back to the washer reservoir. This drain-back would result in a lengthy delay from when the rear washer switch is actuated until washer fluid was dispensed through the rear washer nozzle, because the rear washer pump would have to refill the rear washer plumbing from the reservoir to the nozzle. Such a drain-back condition could also result in water, dirt, or other outside contaminants being siphoned into the washer system through the washer nozzle orifice. This water could subsequently freeze and plug the nozzle, while other contaminants could interfere with proper nozzle operation and cause improper nozzle spray patterns. In addition, the rear check valve prevents washer fluid from siphoning out through the rear washer nozzle after the rear washer system is turned Off.

When the rear washer pump pressurizes and pumps washer fluid from the reservoir through the rear washer plumbing, the fluid pressure unseats a check ball from a seat within the valve by overriding the pressure applied to the ball within the valve by a small coiled spring (Fig. 4). With the check ball unseated, washer fluid is allowed to flow toward the rear washer nozzle. When the washer pump stops operating, the spring pressure on the check ball seats